MONITORING, EVALUATION AND OUTCOMES

RESULTS CHAIN → CLASSIFY THE STATISTIC → INSTITUTIONAL MAP → EVALUATION CRITERIA SET → COVERAGE DISCIPLINE CARD → THREE BUDGETING MODES

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◈ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 RESULTS CHAIN

RESULTS CHAIN · MONEY, STAFF AND MATERIALS COMMITTED TO THE INTERVENTION · WHAT WAS ACTUALLY DONE, SUCH AS TRAINING CONDUCTED OR · WHAT WAS DIRECTLY PRODUCED, SUCH AS KILOMETRES OF ROAD · THE CHANGE IN THE TARGET POPULATION, SUCH AS TRAVEL · THE WIDER, LONGER-TERM CHANGE IN ACCESS, INCOME OR MOBILITY · REPORTING STOPS · MOST INDIAN SCHEME REPORTING HALTS AT THE OUTPUT RUNG

INPUT → money, staff and materials committed to the intervention → **ACTIVITY: what was actually done, such as training conducted or pipes laid** → **OUTPUT: what was directly produced, such as kilometres of road or schools built** → **OUTCOME: the change in the target population, such as travel time or learning** → **IMPACT: the wider, longer-term change in access, income or mobility**

CORE CLAIM
- INPUT → money, staff and materials committed to the intervention
- ACTIVITY: what was actually done, such as training conducted or pipes laid
- OUTPUT: what was directly produced, such as kilometres of road or schools built

MECHANISM
- OUTCOME: the change in the target population, such as travel time or learning
- IMPACT: the wider, longer-term change in access, income or mobility
- REPORTING STOPS → most Indian scheme reporting halts at the output rung

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- MUST REMEMBER: Monitoring tracks implementation continuously, evaluation judges...

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MUST REMEMBER: Monitoring tracks implementation continuously, evaluation judges.

01

STAGE 01 CLASSIFY THE STATISTIC

CLASSIFY THE STATISTIC · OUTPUT CLAIM · SHARE OF HOUSEHOLDS COVERED; NUMBER OF FACILITIES CONSTRUCTED · OUTCOME CLAIM · WATER QUALITY AT THE POINT OF USE; MEASURED LEARNING · IMPACT CLAIM · MARKET ACCESS, HOUSEHOLD INCOME, MOBILITY OVER YEARS · EXAM MOVE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
OUTPUT CLAIM → share of households covered; number of facilities constructed	IMPACT CLAIM → market access, household income, mobility over years	OUTPUT CLAIM → share of households covered; number of facilities constructed
OUTCOME CLAIM → water quality at the point of use; measured learning level	EXAM MOVE → name the rung of the figure the stem supplies before using it	OUTCOME CLAIM → water quality at the point of use; measured learning level

CORE CLAIM
- OUTPUT CLAIM → share of households covered; number of facilities constructed
- OUTCOME CLAIM → water quality at the point of use; measured learning level

MECHANISM
- IMPACT CLAIM → market access, household income, mobility over years
- EXAM MOVE → name the rung of the figure the stem supplies before using it

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- OUTPUT CLAIM → share of households covered; number of facilities constructed
- OUTCOME CLAIM → water quality at the point of use; measured learning level

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EXAM MOVE → name the rung of the figure the stem supplies before using it.

02

STAGE 02 INSTITUTIONAL MAP

INSTITUTIONAL MAP · EVALUATION OFFICE · ATTACHED OFFICE OF NITI AAYOG; CONSTITUTED SEPTEMBER 2015 · FORMED BY MERGING · PROGRAM EVALUATION OFFICE AND INDEPENDENT EVALUATION OFFICE · BUDGET FRAMEWORK · MINISTRY OF FINANCE, BUDGET DIVISION; DUAL OUTPUT AND OUTCOME · DISTRICT PROGRAMME

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
EVALUATION OFFICE → attached office of NITI Aayog; constituted September 2015	BUDGET FRAMEWORK → Ministry of Finance, Budget Division; dual output and outcome reporting	LIMIT → the evaluator produces evidence and cannot redesign the scheme
FORMED BY MERGING → Program Evaluation Office and Independent Evaluation Office	DISTRICT PROGRAMME → Champions of Change dashboard with delta ranking	EVALUATION OFFICE → attached office of NITI Aayog; constituted September 2015

CORE CLAIM
- EVALUATION OFFICE → attached office of NITI Aayog; constituted September 2015
- FORMED BY MERGING → Program Evaluation Office and Independent Evaluation Office

MECHANISM
- BUDGET FRAMEWORK → Ministry of Finance, Budget Division; dual output and outcome reporting
- DISTRICT PROGRAMME → Champions of Change dashboard with delta ranking

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- LIMIT → the evaluator produces evidence and cannot redesign the scheme
- EVALUATION OFFICE → attached office of NITI Aayog; constituted September 2015

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → the evaluator produces evidence and cannot redesign the scheme.

03

STAGE 03 EVALUATION CRITERIA SET

EVALUATION CRITERIA SET · WAS THE INTERVENTION THE RIGHT RESPONSE TO THE PROBLEM · EFFECTIVENESS AND EFFICIENCY · WAS THE OBJECTIVE MET, AND AT WHAT COST · SUSTAINABILITY AND IMPACT · DOES THE CHANGE PERSIST, AND HOW WIDE IS IT · COHERENCE AND EQUITY · DOES IT FIT OTHER POLICY, AND WHO GAINED AND

CORE CLAIM
- RELEVANCE → was the intervention the right response to the problem
- EFFECTIVENESS and EFFICIENCY → was the objective met, and at what cost

MECHANISM
- SUSTAINABILITY and IMPACT → does the change persist, and how wide is it
- COHERENCE and EQUITY → does it fit other policy, and who gained and who did not

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- RELEVANCE → was the intervention the right response to the problem
- EFFECTIVENESS and EFFICIENCY → was the objective met, and at what cost

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COHERENCE and EQUITY → does it fit other policy, and who gained and who did not.

04

STAGE 04 COVERAGE DISCIPLINE CARD

COVERAGE DISCIPLINE CARD · THE BUDGET FRAMEWORK DOES NOT COVER EVERY SCHEME IN · 2026-27 DOCUMENT COVERS 172 MAJOR SCHEMES · AN OUTLAY OF FIVE HUNDRED CRORE RUPEES OR MORE · CITE WITH THE BUDGET YEAR AND NEVER CARRY THE

RULE → the budget framework does not cover every scheme in every year → **OWNER-VERIFIED → 2026-27 document covers 172 major schemes** → **THRESHOLD → an outlay of five hundred crore rupees or more in that document** → **DISCIPLINE → cite with the Budget year and never carry the figure forward**

CORE CLAIM
- RULE → the budget framework does not cover every scheme in every year
- OWNER-VERIFIED → 2026-27 document covers 172 major schemes

MECHANISM
- THRESHOLD → an outlay of five hundred crore rupees or more in that document
- DISCIPLINE → cite with the Budget year and never carry the figure forward

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- RULE → the budget framework does not cover every scheme in every year
- OWNER-VERIFIED → 2026-27 document covers 172 major schemes

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → the budget framework does not cover every scheme in every year.

05

STAGE 05 THREE BUDGETING MODES

THREE BUDGETING MODES · INPUT BUDGETING · LINE ITEMS; HOW MUCH MONEY WAS ALLOCATED TO A · OUTPUT BUDGETING · PHYSICAL UNITS PRODUCED FOR THE ALLOCATION · OUTCOME BUDGETING · THE CHANGE ACHIEVED RELATIVE TO THE ALLOCATION · OUTCOME ACHIEVEMENT CARRIES NO BUDGETARY CONSEQUENCE

INPUT BUDGETING → line items; how much money was allocated to a category

OUTPUT BUDGETING → physical units produced for the allocation → **OUTCOME BUDGETING → the change achieved relative to the allocation** → **UNFINISHED → outcome achievement carries no budgetary consequence**

CORE CLAIM
- INPUT BUDGETING → line items; how much money was allocated to a category
- OUTPUT BUDGETING → physical units produced for the allocation

MECHANISM
- OUTCOME BUDGETING → the change achieved relative to the allocation
- UNFINISHED → outcome achievement carries no budgetary consequence

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Indicator is not target, output is not outcome, outcome is not...
- INPUT BUDGETING → line items; how much money was allocated to a category

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Indicator is not target, output is not outcome, outcome is not.

06

STAGE 06 DISTRICT AND BLOCK PROGRAMMES KEPT SEPARATE

DISTRICT AND BLOCK PROGRAMMES KEPT SEPARATE · DISTRICT PROGRAMME · 112 DISTRICTS; 49 KEY PERFORMANCE INDICATORS; FIVE THEMES · FIVE THEMES · HEALTH AND NUTRITION; EDUCATION; AGRICULTURE AND WATER RESOURCES · FINANCIAL INCLUSION AND SKILL DEVELOPMENT; BASIC INFRASTRUCTURE · BLOCK PROGRAMME · 513 BLOCKS IN CURRENT NITI AAYOG MATERIAL; A FINER

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
DISTRICT PROGRAMME → 112 districts; 49 key performance indicators; five themes	FIVE THEMES → financial inclusion and skill development; basic infrastructure	ERROR TO AVOID → merging district and block counts or their indicator sets
FIVE THEMES → health and nutrition; education; agriculture and water resources	BLOCK PROGRAMME → 513 blocks in current NITI Aayog material; a finer unit	DISTRICT PROGRAMME → 112 districts; 49 key performance indicators; five themes

CORE CLAIM
- DISTRICT PROGRAMME → 112 districts; 49 key performance indicators; five themes
- FIVE THEMES → health and nutrition; education; agriculture and water resources

MECHANISM
- FIVE THEMES → financial inclusion and skill development; basic infrastructure
- BLOCK PROGRAMME → 513 blocks in current NITI Aayog material; a finer unit

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- ERROR TO AVOID → merging district and block counts or their indicator sets
- DISTRICT PROGRAMME → 112 districts; 49 key performance indicators; five themes

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ERROR TO AVOID → merging district and block counts or their indicator sets.

07

STAGE 07 RANKING DESIGN

RANKING DESIGN · ABSOLUTE RANKING · COMPARES PRESENT LEVEL; ALREADY-ADVANTAGED UNITS STAY ON TOP · DELTA RANKING · COMPARES THE RATE OF IMPROVEMENT OVER A DEFINED PERIOD · A HISTORICALLY DISADVANTAGED DISTRICT IS NOT PERMANENTLY PLACED AT · BASELINE UNDERSTATEMENT INFLATES APPARENT IMPROVEMENT · CAREFUL BASELINE-SETTING PLUS INDEPENDENT VALIDATION OF THE DATA

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
ABSOLUTE RANKING → compares present level; already-advantaged units stay on top	GAIN → a historically disadvantaged district is not permanently placed at the bottom	CONDITION → careful baseline-setting plus independent validation of the data
DELTA RANKING → compares the rate of improvement over a defined period	RISK → baseline understatement inflates apparent improvement	ABSOLUTE RANKING → compares present level; already-advantaged units stay on top

CORE CLAIM
- ABSOLUTE RANKING → compares present level; already-advantaged units stay on top
- DELTA RANKING → compares the rate of improvement over a defined period

MECHANISM
- GAIN → a historically disadvantaged district is not permanently placed at the bottom
- RISK → baseline understatement inflates apparent improvement

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CONDITION → careful baseline-setting plus independent validation of the data
- ABSOLUTE RANKING → compares present level; already-advantaged units stay on top

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONDITION → careful baseline-setting plus independent validation of the data.

08

STAGE 08 MONITORING AGAINST EVALUATION

MONITORING AGAINST EVALUATION · CONTINUOUS, HIGH FREQUENCY, TYPICALLY SELF-REPORTED ADMINISTRATIVE DATA · ITS USE · RAPID COURSE CORRECTION WHILE THE PROGRAMME IS RUNNING · PERIODIC, OFTEN INDEPENDENT, ASSESSES WHETHER OUTCOMES WERE ACHIEVED · SCHEME REDESIGN AND RESOURCE REALLOCATION AFTER THE EVIDENCE IS · NEITHER SUBSTITUTES FOR THE OTHER AND EACH FAILS IN

CORE CLAIM
- MONITORING → continuous, high frequency, typically self-reported administrative data
- ITS USE → rapid course correction while the programme is running

MECHANISM
- EVALUATION → periodic, often independent, assesses whether outcomes were achieved
- ITS USE → scheme redesign and resource reallocation after the evidence is in

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- RULE → neither substitutes for the other and each fails in a different way
- MONITORING → continuous, high frequency, typically self-reported administrative data

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → neither substitutes for the other and each fails in a different way.

09

STAGE 09 METHOD AND LIMIT TABLE

METHOD AND LIMIT TABLE · BEFORE AND AFTER · SHOWS MOVEMENT; CANNOT SEPARATE THE INTERVENTION FROM EVERYTHING ELSE · WITH AND WITHOUT · PLAUSIBLE COUNTERFACTUAL; THE COMPARISON GROUP MAY DIFFER SYSTEMATICALLY · RANDOMISED TRIAL · CAUSAL EFFECT FOR THE DESIGN STUDIED; LIMITED EXTERNAL VALIDITY · CAUSAL INFERENCE WITHOUT RANDOMISATION; ASSUMPTIONS CAN FAIL

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
BEFORE AND AFTER → shows movement; cannot separate the intervention from everything else	RANDOMISED TRIAL → causal effect for the design studied; limited external validity	PROCESS EVALUATION → explains why an outcome occurred; no effect size
WITH AND WITHOUT → plausible counterfactual; the comparison group may differ systematically	QUASI-EXPERIMENTAL → causal inference without randomisation; assumptions can fail	ADMINISTRATIVE DATA → continuous and cheap; only as good as the reporter's incentive

CORE CLAIM
- BEFORE AND AFTER → shows movement; cannot separate the intervention from everything else
- WITH AND WITHOUT → plausible counterfactual; the comparison group may differ systematically

MECHANISM
- RANDOMISED TRIAL → causal effect for the design studied; limited external validity
- QUASI-EXPERIMENTAL → causal inference without randomisation; assumptions can fail

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- PROCESS EVALUATION → explains why an outcome occurred; no effect size
- ADMINISTRATIVE DATA → continuous and cheap; only as good as the reporter's incentive

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ADMINISTRATIVE DATA → continuous and cheap; only as good as the reporter's incentive.

10

STAGE 10 INDICATOR FAILURE MODES AND CORRECTIONS

INDICATOR FAILURE MODES AND CORRECTIONS · A MEASURE WITH CONSEQUENCES IS PRODUCED RATHER THAN OBSERVED · THE JUDGED ENTITY GENERATES THE NUMBER; VALIDATE A SAMPLE · AGGREGATION MASKING · THE AVERAGE HIDES BLOCK AND GROUP FAILURE; DISAGGREGATE BY · OUTPUT SUBSTITUTION · EFFORT MOVES TO WHAT IS COUNTED; ADD QUALITY AND · SELECTION EFFECTS

GOODHART → a measure with consequences is produced rather than observed; use a basket → **SELF-REPORTED → the judged entity generates the number; validate a sample independently** → **AGGREGATION MASKING → the average hides block and group failure; disaggregate by rule** → **OUTPUT SUBSTITUTION → effort moves to what is counted; add quality and outcome measures** → **SELECTION EFFECTS → only reachable beneficiaries are measured; report drop-off**

CORE CLAIM
- GOODHART → a measure with consequences is produced rather than observed; use a basket
- SELF-REPORTED → the judged entity generates the number; validate a sample independently

MECHANISM
- AGGREGATION MASKING → the average hides block and group failure; disaggregate by rule
- OUTPUT SUBSTITUTION → effort moves to what is counted; add quality and outcome measures

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- SELECTION EFFECTS → only reachable beneficiaries are measured; report drop-off
- DEFINITION DRIFT → the definition changes between years; publish definitions and breaks

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: AGGREGATION MASKING → the average hides block and group failure; disaggregate by rule.

11

STAGE 11 ANSWER SPINE FOR AN EVALUATE DEMAND

ANSWER SPINE FOR AN EVALUATE DEMAND · SAY WHAT AN OUTPUT CLAIM PROVES AND WHAT IT · PLACE THE EVIDENCE ON THE RESULTS CHAIN AND NAME · STATE THE COUNTERFACTUAL REQUIRED AND THE GAMING RISK IN · GRADED VERDICT ABOUT THE EVALUATION DESIGN AS MUCH AS · EVIDENCE LIMIT · USE ASPIRATIONAL DISTRICTS, OUTCOME

OPEN → say what an output claim proves and what it does not, before citing → **BUILD → place the evidence on the results chain and name the missing baseline** → **CORRECT → state the counterfactual required and the gaming risk in the indicator** → **CLOSE → graded verdict about the evaluation design as much as about the scheme** → **EVIDENCE LIMIT: AUTHORITY / IMPLEMENTATION: Use Aspirational Districts, outcome**

CORE CLAIM
- OPEN → say what an output claim proves and what it does not, before citing anything
- BUILD → place the evidence on the results chain and name the missing baseline

MECHANISM
- CORRECT → state the counterfactual required and the gaming risk in the indicator
- CLOSE → graded verdict about the evaluation design as much as about the scheme

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: AUTHORITY / IMPLEMENTATION: Use Aspirational Districts, outcome...
- OPEN → say what an output claim proves and what it does not, before citing anything

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → graded verdict about the evaluation design as much as about the scheme.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · THE DISTINCTION BETWEEN MONITORING AND EVALUATION MAPS ONTO A · DELTA-RANKING'S INCENTIVE-COMPATIBILITY (REWARDING IMPROVEMENT REGARDLESS OF STARTING · OUTCOME BUDGETING'S FULL MATURITY REQUIRES CREDIBLE CAUSAL ATTRIBUTION (SHOWING · DMEO WAS FORMED IN 2015 SPECIFICALLY BY MERGING THE · THE OUTPUT-OUTCOME MONITORING FRAMEWORK IS ISSUED/UPDATED BY THE MINISTRY · THE ASPIRATIONAL DISTRICTS PROGRAMME'S DASHBOARD ARCHITECTURE (MONTHLY OFFICER-REPORTED · A DISTRICT SHOWING STRONG MONTH-ON-MONTH IMPROVEMENT IN AN ADP

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH
- CAUTION: The distinction between monitoring and evaluation maps onto a broader governance-design
- CAUTION: Delta-ranking's incentive-compatibility (rewarding improvement regardless of starting
- CAUTION: Outcome budgeting's full maturity requires credible causal attribution (showing the
- DMEO was formed in 2015 specifically by merging the Programme Evaluation Organisation

ADVANCED DEBATE
- The Output-Outcome Monitoring Framework is issued/updated by the Ministry of Finance's
- The Aspirational Districts Programme's dashboard architecture (monthly officer-reported
- CAUTION: A district showing strong month-on-month improvement in an ADP health KPI despite a low
- CAUTION: Boundary case: a district reporting an implausibly large one-month KPI jump raises a

LEGACY / NUANCE
- CAUTION: A DMEO third-party evaluation finding a scheme's outputs fully achieved but its
- CAUTION: High-frequency, self-reported monitoring (ADP-style) trades some data rigor for speed
- CAUTION: Outcome budgeting's causal-attribution demands are methodologically harder to satisfy
- CAUTION: Delta-ranking's fairness benefit (not penalising historical disadvantage) must be

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels